

Mina Afrouzi Khosroshahi

Contact Information

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Education

The Graduate Center, CUNY, New York, NY
Ph.D. in Economics (Fifth Year)

August 2022 – Present

University of Tehran, Tehran, Iran
Certificate of Business Administration, Entrepreneurship

September 2020 – January 2022

Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran
B.A. in Economics

January 2014 – June 2018

Research Experience

Research Foundation of CUNY (RF CUNY), New York, NY
Research Assistant—Professor Theodore Joyce, PI

July 2025 – Present

– Conducted econometric analysis, using administrative data from a large urban public university system.

Publication:

"Standardized Test Scores and Academic Performance at a Public University System"

Co-authors: Theodore Joyce, Sarah Truelsch, Kerstin Gentsch, Kyle Du

Journal of Public Economics, Vol. 262, Article 105774 (2026) doi.org/10.1016/j.jpubeco.2026.105774

In this paper, we evaluate whether re-establishing SAT requirements at a large urban public university system improves the predictability of academic outcomes. We find that contrary to recent studies of elite private institutions, High School GPA (HSGPA) is the dominant predictor of success in this broad-access system, with a one-standard-deviation increase in HSGPA being four to six times more predictive of six-year graduation than a comparable increase in SAT scores. Using Gelbach and Shapley decompositions, we demonstrate that SAT scores provide redundant information once HSGPA and high school fixed effects are accounted for. Furthermore, our out-of-sample forecasts for the post-COVID period (2020–2023) confirm that test-optional models relying on HSGPA experience very little loss in predictive accuracy. Finally, we find no evidence of calibration bias across racial or socioeconomic subgroups, suggesting that HSGPA is a fair and robust metric for identifying degree completion potential in public university populations.

Teaching Experience

Baruch College, CUNY, New York, NY
Adjunct Lecturer

August 2026 – Present

– *Introduction to Microeconomics* (Fall 2026)

Hunter College, CUNY, New York, NY
Adjunct Lecturer

August 2024 – August 2026

- *International Finance* (Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- *Intermediate Microeconomics* (Summer 2025, Spring 2026, Summer 2026)
- *Principles of Microeconomics* (Spring 2025, Summer 2026)

City College, CUNY, New York, NY
Adjunct Lecturer

August 2025 – December 2025

- *Money and Banking* (Fall 2025)

The Graduate Center, CUNY, New York, NY
Teaching Assistant

August 2023 – August 2025

- *Ph.D. Macroeconomics I & II*

Skills

- **Software:** Stata, R, MATLAB, L^AT_EX, Python, Adobe Creative Suite
- **Languages:** English (Fluent); Persian, Azeri (Native); Turkish (Intermediate)
- **Analytical:** Large-scale administrative data analysis, policy evaluation, and financial reporting.

Professional Experience & Service

Graduate Center Budget Committee
Member

August 2023 – May 2025

- Participated in departmental fiscal oversight and strategic resource allocation meetings.

Donya-e-Eqtasad Newspaper, Tehran, Iran
Journalist & Content Contributor

January 2014 – January 2020

- Analyzed and reported on financial market trends and macroeconomic developments for Iran's leading economic daily.
- Provided data-driven insights on global economic trends to an audience of policymakers and financial professionals.
- Translated and adapted high-level management, business, and economic research articles from global sources for Persian-speaking audiences.
- Contributed to the expansion of accessible global economic discourse through regular content creation and editorial collaboration.

Awards

Ray Quinlan Student Fellowship

2023, 2025

Awarded for academic excellence and contributions to the Economics Ph.D. program.